

INTERNSHIP PROJECT PROPOSAL REPORT

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report outlines three commercially viable website development projects identified as high-potential solutions to critical problems in Ethiopia. Each project addresses a genuine market gap, has a clear revenue model, and can be built as a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) within a short timeframe.

The three selected projects are:

1. Market Price Aggregator – Sector: Agriculture / Trade – Revenue Potential: High (Subscription-based)
2. Hyper-local Service Bidding – Sector: Service Industry – Revenue Potential: Medium-High (Commission-based)
3. Vacancy Alert System – Sector: Real Estate – Revenue Potential: Medium (Premium Access)

All three projects share common advantages:

- Low development cost (can be built with standard web technologies)
- Scalable (can grow from Addis Ababa to regional cities)
- Solvable with a simple web interface combined with mobile-responsive design

PROJECT 1: MARKET PRICE AGGREGATOR

1. The Problem We Are Solving

Current Situation:

- Ethiopia has highly volatile commodity prices due to inflation, fuel costs, and seasonal changes.
- Small business owners (restaurants, cafes, wholesalers, street vendors) and farmers do not have access to real-time, reliable market price data.
- They rely on word-of-mouth, calling multiple contacts, or physically visiting markets—all of which are time-consuming and costly.
- This lack of transparency leads to:
 - Traders buying at inflated prices.
 - Farmers selling below market value because they don't know better.
 - Restaurants losing profit margins due to unpredictable ingredient costs.

2. How It Solves the Problem

The Solution:

A daily-updated web dashboard showing wholesale and retail prices for 20+ essential commodities across Ethiopia's major markets (Mercato, Shola, Bahir Dar, Hawassa, Dire Dawa, etc.).

Key Features:

- Daily price updates (via a network of data collectors).

- Historical price trends shown as graphical charts.
- City-to-market comparison tool.
- SMS and Telegram alerts for price drops or spikes.
- Mobile-friendly design for smartphone users.

How It Works:

- Data collectors visit markets daily and input prices into a backend system.
- The website displays the data in real-time.
- Subscribers get access to advanced features (alerts, comparisons, downloadable reports).

3. Target Audience

Restaurant and Cafe Owners – They face high food costs and need to buy ingredients at the lowest possible price.

Small Wholesalers – They are losing margins and need to negotiate better with suppliers.

Farmers – They often sell too low and need to know fair market value before going to market.

Government and Researchers – They need reliable data for policy-making and inflation tracking.

4. Our Value Proposition

> "Stop guessing what to pay. Know the real market price before you buy or sell—updated daily, straight from Ethiopia's biggest markets."

Unique Selling Points (USPs):

- First-mover advantage—no such service exists in Ethiopia today.
- Hyper-local accuracy—prices come from specific markets, not national averages.
- Actionable insights—price trends help users decide when to buy or sell.
- Multiple delivery channels—website, SMS, and Telegram bot.

5. Revenue Model

Premium Subscription (B2B) – For restaurants, hotels, and wholesalers. Provides unlimited access plus price alerts.

Pay-Per-Report – One-time download of a detailed price report.

Data Licensing – Sell aggregated data to research institutions or NGOs. Price is negotiable (annual contracts).

Sponsored Listings – Featured listings for specific markets or traders.

6. Development Requirements

Tech Stack: HTML/CSS/JavaScript for the frontend, Node.js or PHP for the backend, MySQL for the database, and Chart.js for graphical visualizations.

Data Collection: 3 to 5 part-time data collectors equipped with smartphones.

Hosting: Shared hosting for the starter phase, or a VPS for scalability.

PROJECT 2: HYPER-LOCAL SERVICE BIDDING

1. The Problem We Are Solving

Current Situation:

- Finding a trusted plumber, electrician, painter, carpenter, or appliance repair technician in Ethiopia is extremely difficult.
- People rely on asking neighbors and friends (word-of-mouth, which is unreliable), walking around neighborhoods looking for signs, or posting on Facebook groups (where scammers or unverified people respond).
- Key problems include:
 - No price transparency—technicians quote arbitrary prices.
 - No accountability—if the job is done poorly, there is no recourse.
 - No verified reviews—you never know if they will actually show up.
 - Wasted time—calling 10 different numbers to get one quote.

2. How It Solves the Problem

The Solution:

A web-based bidding platform where a user posts a service request (e.g., "Fix broken water pipe in Bole"), and up to 5 verified technicians submit their quotes (price + time estimate). The user compares bids and selects one.

Key Features:

- User posts a job with description, location, and preferred time.
- Verified technicians receive a notification and bid on the job.
- Users see ratings, reviews, and previous work photos of technicians.
- In-app chat for questions before hiring.
- Post-service review system to build trust over time.

How It Works:

- User creates a request for free.
- The system matches the request to relevant technicians based on category and location.
- Technicians bid with their price and estimated time.
- The user picks the best bid.
- The technician completes the job.
- The user rates the service.

Busy Professionals – They have no time to hunt for technicians and value convenience and speed.

Homeowners – They fear overpaying and want price comparison.

Elderly and Disabled Individuals – They have difficulty finding help and need an easy, one-click service.

Skilled Technicians – They need to find new customers and benefit from free exposure and lead generation.

4. Our Value Proposition

> "The Uber of repair services—post what you need, get real quotes from verified pros, and pick the best one. No more calling around."

Unique Selling Points (USPs):

- Verified technicians—every professional is vetted before they join.
- Transparent pricing—competitive bids drive prices down.
- Customer protection—ratings ensure quality and accountability.
- Fast turnaround—quotes are received within 2 to 4 hours.

5. Revenue Model

Bid Fee (per quote) – Technicians pay a small fee to submit a bid. Estimated price: 30–50 Birr per bid.

Commission – A percentage of the final job value, collected via Telebirr or Bank. Estimated: 5–10% of the job value.

Premium Listing – Technicians pay to appear at the top of search results. Estimated price:

Promotion and Ads – Featured service providers (e.g., "Verified Electrician of the Month").

6. Development Requirements

Verification Process: In-person or document-based vetting of all technicians.

Hosting: Cloud hosting (AWS or DigitalOcean) for scalability.

PROJECT 3: VACANCY ALERT SYSTEM

1. The Problem We Are Solving

Current Situation:

- Finding a house, office, or shop for rent in Addis Ababa is a nightmare.
- Renters drive around neighborhoods for days looking for "For Rent" signs.
- They scour Telegram channels and Facebook groups—but posts disappear quickly.
- They contact agents who often have outdated or fake listings.
- They waste weeks of time and money on transport.
- Property owners struggle to find trustworthy tenants quickly.
- Owners rely on agents who take large commissions.

- No centralized, real-time, verified database of available properties exists.

2. How It Solves the Problem

The Solution:

A searchable web platform that aggregates all available rental properties in Addis Ababa (and regional cities) into one clean, map-based interface. Users can filter by price, location, number of bedrooms, and property type.

Key Features:

- Interactive map showing property locations.
- Detailed listings with photos, price, size, and contact information.
- Alert system—users get email or Telegram notifications when new properties matching their criteria are posted.
- Verified listings—agents and property owners pay to list, but we verify authenticity.
- Owner-direct—users contact owners or agents directly without intermediaries.

How It Works:

- Property owners and agents post listings with photos and details.
- Admin verifies the listing (basic validation).
- Users search, filter, and view properties.
- Users with Premium Access see contact information (phone numbers).
- Free users see the address and description but must pay to unlock contact details.

3. Target Audience

Renters (House and Office) – They waste time driving around and want to search everything from home.

New Arrivals (Students and Employees) – They have no local knowledge and need a one-stop shop for all listings.

Real Estate Agents – They need to find qualified buyers and benefit from a high-exposure platform.

Property Owners – They have vacant properties losing money and need fast tenant matching.

4. Our Value Proposition

> "Stop driving around for hours. Find your next home or office in minutes—with real-time alerts for new listings that match exactly what you want."

Unique Selling Points (USPs):

- Centralized database—all listings in one place (currently fragmented across Telegram and Facebook).
- Alert system—first-mover advantage; no other platform sends personalized alerts.
- Verified listings—reduces scams and fake posts.
- User-friendly search—filter by price, size, location, and property type.

5. Revenue Model

Premium Access (B2C) – Users pay to unlock contact details of listings.

Listing Fee (B2B) – Agents and owners pay to list a property.

Featured Listing – Boost a property to the top of search results.

Bulk Package – Agents buy bulk listing credits (e.g., 50 listings for a discount).